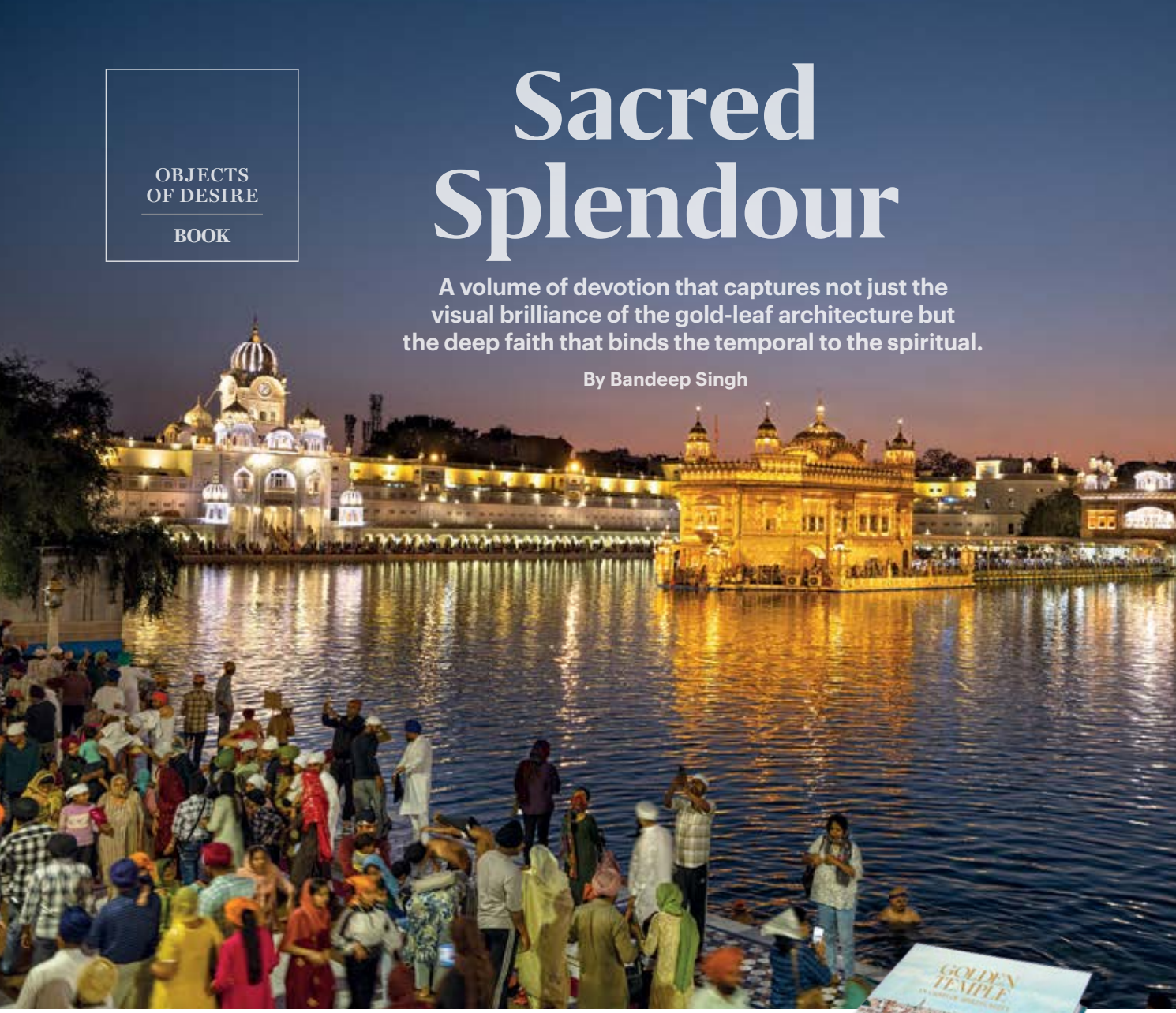
OBJECTS OF DESIRE

BOOK

Sacred Splendour

A volume of devotion that captures not just the visual brilliance of the gold-leaf architecture but the deep faith that binds the temporal to the spiritual.

By Bandeep Singh



Instinctively, you hesitate before setting this book down on any surface—for it comes wrapped in an aura of a *Granth*, a sacred tome. That its subject is the epicentre of Sikh faith, the holiest of shrines, and that its physical form mirrors that sanctity, marks it out immediately: less a publication than an object of reverence.

This magnificently produced, illustrated volume by publisher Om Arora, is housed in an embossed saffron box with a custom padded bag. The hardbound book is adorned by an intricate 19th century miniature painting, celebrating the rhythms of faith and everyday devotion around Harmandir Sahib, the Golden temple. Every production choice—from the fine paper and immaculate printing to the choreography of photographs and text—echoes the grandeur and spiritual importance of the shrine it honours. When you hold it, you understand that this is not a book but an offering.

Within its pages, photographer Tarun Chopra's keenly observed images trace the gilded splendour of Harimandir Sahib as it dissolves and reforms in the waters of the sarovar, across



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